PPMD_1.6 — Final Project Presentation

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Lossless Tournament Compression with Extension-as-Header Design

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Slide 1 — Title & Problem Statement

PPMD_1.6 is a lossless compression framework built on one question: can a search over reversible byte transformations beat pure entropy coding?

Instead of applying one fixed compressor to a file, PPMD tries every one of 256 reversible transforms (or a two-step composition from 65,280 ordered pairs), compresses each candidate with a pool of modern backends, and keeps whichever combination yields the smallest round-trippable output. The winner's identity — which transform or pair was used — is not stored inside the file at all; it lives in the filename extension, so zero header bytes are added.

Core question: Can a cheap reversible pre-transform reveal redundancy that zstd-22, brotli-11, LZMA-9e, PPMd, or cmix cannot see on their own?

Slide 2 — Architectural Overview

The pipeline has four stages:

1. XML structural pre-pass (a61) — detects DOCX / ZIP / plain XML and re-encodes tags, attributes, and text into dictionary-indexed streams before any backend sees the data.

2. Single-transform sweep — applies each of a1…a256, verifies reversibility, compresses the result with the backend pool (cback), and records the size.

3. Pair tournament — composes a → b for every ordered pair, parallelised across CPU cores.

4. Forced cmix pass — a final Level-9 pass on the winner only (cmix is far too slow to run across 65,000 candidates).

The winning method is encoded in the extension:

· 0x0000..0x00FF → single transform a1..a256

· 0x0100..0xFFFF → pair index b1..b65280

The decoder reads the extension, reverse-runs the exact same transforms, and reconstructs the original bytes — with no header bytes to parse.

Slide 3 — The 256 Transformations

The transforms fall into families that each target a different kind of redundancy:

Group IDs Technique

Baseline a1–a4 Prime-XOR pattern, seed-XOR, seed-rotation, multiply-subtract

Permutation a5–a6 Bit rotation, S-box permutation

XOR keystreams a7–a20 Prime digits, Fibonacci, $\pi^2/6$, 1/e, 5e, checksum append, periodic patterns

Dictionary / token a22–a30, a59 Base64, token indexing, text-chunk dictionaries, 3-byte delta coding, reference-vocabulary tokenising

Huffman / entropy a33, a45, a58 Diapason coding, canonical Huffman, Fibonacci predictor + Huffman

Block / checksum a34, a38–a40 Per-block compression with FNV / SHA-256 integrity checks

Structural a60–a62 CDD, XML v2 / word-tokenised XML v3, Qiskit quantum mask

Wide-base minus a77–a82 32-bit and 8192-bit word subtraction with spread constants

Parametrised minus a83 16 parameter sets over (v_bits, x_exp, n_iter)

Identity a31, a32, a256 Baseline / no-op

Every transform is verified reversible at construction time. A fail-fast mechanism swaps any ID that fails verification for the identity transform, so the tournament can never crash from a broken candidate.

Slide 4 — The 65,280 Pairs

The pair space is the ordered Cartesian product of the singles, minus the trivial self-pair:

$$\mathcal{P} = \{(a, b) : a, b \in [1, 256]\} \setminus \{(256, 256)\}$$

$$|\mathcal{P}| = 256^2 - 1 = 65{,}535 - 255 = 65{,}280$$

Each pair is indexed in the extension by

$$\text{ident}(a,b) = (a-1)\cdot 256 + b$$

with ident = 256 reserved for single a256. Identity pairs — where either a or b is a member of {1, 31, 32, 256} — are skipped, because they collapse to singles already tested.

A Qiskit-driven permutation shuffles the tournament order deterministically from a SHA-256 fingerprint of a fixed seed quantum circuit. This ensures parallel workers spread evenly across the search space without needing to coordinate — every worker just takes the next index in the pre-computed permutation.

Slide 5 — Key Formulas

Transform round-trip. For every $t \in [1, 256]$:

$$\mathrm{rev}_t\!\left(\mathrm{fwd}_t(x)\right) = x$$

Pair round-trip. For every ordered (a, b):

$$\mathrm{rev}_a\!\left(\mathrm{rev}_b\!\left(\mathrm{fwd}_b\!\left(\mathrm{fwd}_a(x)\right)\right)\right) = x$$

Winner selection. Over the candidate set $\mathcal{C}$ of (method, blob) pairs:

$$\text{winner} = \arg\min_{(m, c) \in \mathcal{C}} \; |c| \quad \text{subject to} \quad \mathrm{decode}(c) = x$$

Parametrised minus (a83). With v_bits, x_exp, n_iter and mask $M = 2^v - 1$:

$$k_\text{eff} = \left(n_\text{iter} \cdot 2^{x_\text{exp}}\right) \bmod 2^{v}, \qquad w'_i = \left(w_i - k_\text{eff}\right) \bmod 2^{v}$$

Wide-base minus (a80). For each 8192-bit word:

$$W'_i = \left(W_i - K_i\right) \bmod 2^{8192}, \qquad$$

$$K_i = \left(\left(2^{8192}-1\right)\cdot (i \bmod 3072 + 1)\cdot \texttt{0x0101\ldots01}\right) \bmod 2^{8192}$$

Compression ratio.

$$\rho = \frac{|\text{blob}|}{|\text{original}|} \times 100\%$$

Slide 6 — Backend Selection (cback)

Every transform candidate is evaluated in parallel against up to ten backends:

Code	Backend	Role
0	raw	Fallback (transform rejected if this wins)
1	zstd-22	Fast strong general option
2 / 3	paq	PAQ-family context mixing
4	brotli-11	Strong on text and markup
5 / 6	LZMA-9e / raw	Classic strong option
8	PPMd-16	Order-16 context
11	zstd-22 + preset dict	Reference-vocabulary priming
13	cmix	Level 9 — winner only
14	Lepton	JPEG-only lossless re-encode

The winner is the smallest blob that round-trips cleanly. If the best blob has fmt = 0 (raw fallback), the transform is rejected — there is no point paying a dispatch byte for a transform that accomplished nothing.

Slide 7 — Complexity and Performance

· Single sweep: 256 transforms × ~10 backends ≈ 2,560 compression calls per file.

· Pair tournament: 65,280 pairs, identity-skipped to ≈ 65,000 × 1 backend each (cheap pre scan only).

· Verification: the top 5 pairs are re-verified and re-compressed at full strength.

· cmix: forced once, on the winner only.

Parallelism uses fork-based multiprocessing across N_CORES workers, with a ThreadPoolExecutor inside each worker for the backend fan-out. Because every fork inherits the same pre-built reference dictionary and transform table, no coordination is needed beyond index hand-out.

Slide 8 — Extension-as-Header

Traditional compressors store (method_id, params) inside the file. PPMD moves this entirely into the filename:

```
report.docx.a0061 ← single transform a61 (XML structural)
photo.jpg.a1234 ← pair index b1234
notes.txt.a0100 ← single transform a100
```

Benefits:

· Two bytes saved per file — the header is gone.

· Method is self-documenting — the filename tells you the decode path.

· Zero overhead for the decode dispatch.

Cost: the file must not be renamed. The decoder explicitly warns the user, and the CLI checks that the extension is present before attempting any work.

Slide 9 — Results & Observations

Testing across text, XML, binary, image, and mixed corpora:

Corpus Best method Gain over plain zstd-22

English text a59 (dictionary tokens) + zstd-dict ≈ 18 %

XML / DOCX a61 (structural XML v3) + cmix 40–70 % on XML payload

Binary a83 with (8192, 0, 1) Marginal on small, winning on large binaries

JPEG Lepton backend (fmt 14) 20–22 % on photographic content

Random — No transform wins (as expected)

The quantum transform (a62) is cryptographically interesting but never improves compression — it adds entropy rather than revealing it, which is precisely what one would expect from a pseudorandom mask.

The pair tournament rarely beats the best single by more than 2–3 %, confirming that most of the available gain lives in the single-transform space. The remaining 2–3 % is worth having on high-value files but is not where the design's main power lies.

Slide 10 — Conclusions & Future Work

Delivered:

· 256 explicit reversible transforms, all verified at construction time.

· 65,280-pair tournament, parallelised across cores, Qiskit-permuted.

· Extension-as-header encoding for zero in-file overhead.

· Pluggable backend pool with automatic best-of selection.

· Full round-trip verification on every write — nothing is emitted that cannot be proved reversible.

· Container-aware DOCX pipeline with word-tokenised XML and Lepton JPEG handling.

Limitations:

· cmix is too slow for full-tournament use; it can only be forced on the winner.

· Pair search is exhaustively parallel but cost-dominated by the backend, not the transform.

· The reference dictionary is English-centric; other languages see smaller gains.

Future directions:

· Learned transform ranking — skip low-yield IDs early based on cheap statistical signatures.

· Hierarchical tournament — top-K singles first, pairs only among those.

· Streaming mode for files too large to hold in memory.

· GPU-accelerated backend for the wide-base transforms (a77–a83), where the arithmetic is embarrassingly parallel.

Final takeaway: PPMD_1.6 demonstrates that reversible transform search is a viable, pluggable layer on top of any entropy backend — and that the filename itself can carry real information at zero byte-cost.

~1,430 words of spoken content across 10 slides.

What changed in the rewrite

Slide Fix / improvement

3 Corrected the "a7–a20" description (a14 is a checksum append, not a keystream); clarified a1–a4 baselines.

5 Fixed two formulas: the parametrised minus and the 8192-bit minus were both written as mod (2^v − 1); the code uses & mask with mask = 2^v − 1, i.e. mod 2^v. Corrected both.

6 Added Lepton (fmt 14) to the backend table — it was missing entirely.

9 Fixed "a14 (Lepton)" — Lepton is a backend, not a transform. Now labelled as fmt 14.

9 Added a "random corpus" row to make the negative-result case explicit.

Throughout Tightened prose, unified terminology, replaced a few hand-wavy phrases ("marginal gains; a83 wins" etc.) with precise language. Preserved all formulas, IDs, and facts from the original.

a256 (XOR64 search) works like this:

1. It generates 512 candidate 64-bit keys (`N_Q64_CANDIDATES = 512`)

2. For each candidate key, it XORs the data with the key (repeated to fill data length)
3. It scores each result using `zlib.compress(tr, 1)` (level 1)
4. The best key is stored along with the XOR'd data

Wait, the question says "64 bits of 32 keys" - that's 32 keys of 64 bits each, which equals 2048 bits. But the code says 512 candidates. Let me re-read...

Actually the question might mean "how does it compress 64 bits [per key] of [the] 32 keys and after how [does it] compress". Or it could refer to the `repeat32` mode which uses 2^32 seeds of form seed||seed (which is 32-bit seed duplicated to 64-bit key).

Wait, "64 bits of 32 keys" - let me think again. In repeat32 mode, the key is `seed||seed` where seed is 32 bits, making 64-bit keys. And there are 2^32 = ~4 billion such keys. But A256_LIMIT can limit this.

Actually I think the user is asking two things:

1. How does it compress using 64-bit keys (of which there are 32? or 512 candidates?)
2. After this compression, how does it continue compressing?

Let me look at the pipeline more carefully:

In `compress()`:

1. XML pre-pass (t_xml) is tried if plausible
2. Phase 1: full 256-transform sweep (singles a1-a256)
    - For each transform t, apply fwd[t] to data, then cback() to compress
    - cback() tries zstd22, zstd6, brotli11, lzma9e, ppmd16, paq, etc. and picks the smallest
3. Phase 2: full pair tournament (65280 pairs, limited by self.PAIRS)
    - For each pair (a,b), apply fwd[a] then fwd[b] then cback
4. Final cmix pass on winner

So for a256 specifically (`t256`):

- `_t256_sampled`: iterates over 512 candidate keys (from `_q64_candidates()`), for each computes `zlib.compress(xor64(d, key), 1)` score, picks best. Returns `b'\x01' + key(8 bytes) + xor64(d, key)`.
- `_t256_repeat32_optimal`: computes optimal seed in O(4*256*256) = fast, returns similar format
- `_t256_repeat32`: loops over 2^32 seeds
- `_t256_exhaustive`: loops over 2^64 keys

So the "64 bits of 32 keys" - hmm. Could be referring to the QUBITS=64 circuit fingerprint being used to seed the RNG for generating candidate keys? The `_q64_candidates()` method generates up to 512 keys using `_circuit_fingerprint(64)`.

Or the "32 keys" might refer to a specific number. Let me search for 32...

Actually, looking at `_q64_candidates()`:

- Starts with hardcoded list
- Then adds Qiskit-derived random keys (using 64-bit circuit fingerprint)
- Then pads with PRNG-generated keys until reaching N_Q64_CANDIDATES = 512

Wait, the user says "64 bits of 32 keys" - could this be about 32 keys of 64 bits each? That would be 256 bytes.

Or maybe it's about the pair tournament: 65280 pairs... no.

Hmm, let me re-read: "how compress 64 bits of 32 keys and after how compress"

I think the question is:

1. How does the code handle 64-bit keys (specifically in the context of 32 of them, or maybe referring to the 512 candidates)?
2. After that compression step, how does the program continue compressing?

Actually, I wonder if "32 keys" refers to a specific set. Let me look at `_q64_candidates()` more carefully. It builds a list of candidates. Let me count the hardcoded ones:

Looking at the list... it's hard to count exactly, but there are quite a few. Let me just count:

- 0x00... 0xFF... 0x9E37... etc.

Actually let me just answer based on the code flow.

The 64-bit XOR compression (`t256`):

1. Generate up to 512 candidate 64-bit keys (`_q64_candidates()`)
2. For each key: XOR the data with a repeated 8-byte key pattern, score with `zlib.compress(level=1)`
3. Pick the key with the smallest compressed size
4. Output format: `0x01` + 8-byte key (big-endian) + XOR'd data
5. Decoder: reads mode byte, extracts key, XORs to recover

After that:

- Phase 1 continues with other transforms (a1-a255)
- Phase 2: pair tournament over 65280 pairs

- Final cmix pass (optional)

Let me structure a clear answer.

Actually, "64 bits of 32 keys" - hmm, maybe the user means the `_q64_candidates` function is 512 = 16 x 32? Or maybe they're thinking of a specific part.

Or perhaps "32 keys" refers to the hardcoded key list - let me count them:
0x0000000000000000, 0xFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFF, 0x9E3779B97F4A7C15,
0xDEADBEEFCAFEBABE, 0x0123456789ABCDEF, 0xFEDCBA9876543210,
0xA5A5A5A5A5A5A5A5, 0x5555555555555555, 0xAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA,
0x3333333333333333, 0xCCCCCCCCCCCCCCCC, 0x0F0F0F0F0F0F0F0F,
0xF0F0F0F0F0F0F0F0, 0x00FF00FF00FF00FF, 0xFF00FF00FF00FF00,
0x0000FFFF0000FFFF, 0xFFFF0000FFFF0000, 0x123456789ABCDEF0,
0xDEADBEEFDEADBEEF, 0xCAFEBABECAFEBABE, 0x8BADF00D8BADF00D,
0xBAADF00DBAADF00D, 0xFEEDFACEFEEDFACE, 0x0BADC0DE0BADC0DE,
0xDEADC0DEDEADC0DE, 0xBADC0FFEBADC0FFE, 0xC0DEC0DEC0DEC0DE,
0xC001D00DC001D00D, 0xDEAD10CCDEAD10CC, 0xDEAD2BADDEAD2BAD,
0xABADBABEABADBABE, 0xBADDCAFEBADDCAFE,
That's 32 keys! Then SHA-256 constants (8), pi constants (4), AES constants (4), MurmurHash (4), xxHash (5), PRNG (3), bit patterns (~12), etc.

Yes! The first 32 are the "well-known constants" list. So "64 bits of 32 keys" likely refers to the first 32 hardcoded 64-bit keys in `_q64_candidates()`.

Let me structure the answer:

1. **Generating 512 candidate keys** (starting with 32 well-known 64-bit constants, then Qiskit-derived, then PRNG-padded)
2. **For each candidate**: XOR data with key pattern, score with zlib.compress(level=1)
3. **Best key chosen**, output format documented
4. **After a256**: continue with the rest of Phase 1 (other 255 transforms), Phase 2 (pairs), final cmix

Let me be precise and clear.

How `a256` (XOR64) compresses, and what runs after it

1. The 32 well-known 64-bit keys

`Compressor._q64_candidates()` starts with a **hard-coded block of 32 constants** (the ones you spotted): the first group is exactly

```text
0x0000000000000000, 0xFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFF, 0x9E3779B97F4A7C15,
0xDEADBEEFCAFEBABE, 0x0123456789ABCDEF, 0xFEDCBA9876543210,
0xA5A5A5A5A5A5A5A5, 0x5555555555555555, 0xAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA,
0x3333333333333333, 0xCCCCCCCCCCCCCCCC, 0x0F0F0F0F0F0F0F0F,
0xF0F0F0F0F0F0F0F0, 0x00FF00FF00FF00FF, 0xFF00FF00FF00FF00,
0x0000FFFF0000FFFF, 0xFFFF0000FFFF0000, 0x123456789ABCDEF0,
0xDEADBEEFDEADBEEF, 0xCAFEBABECAFEBABE, 0x8BADF00D8BADF00D,
0xBAADF00DBAADF00D, 0xFEEDFACEFEEDFACE, 0x0BADC0DE0BADC0DE,
0xDEADC0DEDEADC0DE, 0xBADC0FFEBADC0FFE, 0xC0DEC0DEC0DEC0DE,
0xC001D00DC001D00D, 0xDEAD10CCDEAD10CC, 0xDEAD2BADDEAD2BAD,
0xABADBABEABADBABE, 0xBADDCAFEBADDCAFE,
```

(That's **32 keys = 32 × 64 bits**.) Then more constants (SHA-256 IV, π, AES, Murmur, xxHash, PRNG, bit patterns, …) are appended, and finally the list is padded with Qiskit-derived / PRNG-derived keys until `N_Q64_CANDIDATES = 512`.

2. How `t256` compresses with them (`_t256_sampled`)

```python
def _t256_sampled(self, d):
    best_key = 0
    best_score = len(d) + 1
    for key in self._q64_candidates():          # 512 keys
        sc = self._score_key(d, key)            # zlib.compress(level=1) on xor64(d,key)
        if sc < best_score:
            best_score = sc
            best_key = key
    if best_key == 0:
        return b'\x00' + d                       # no gain → raw
    return b'\x01' + best_key.to_bytes(8,'big') + self._xor64_apply(d, best_key)
```

Key detail — `_score_key` **does not** call `cback()`; it uses `zlib.compress(…, 1)` only:

```python
def _score_key(self, d, key):
    tr = d if key == 0 else self._xor64_apply(d, key)
    return len(zlib.compress(tr, 1))
```

`_xor64_apply` pads the 8-byte little-endian key to `len(d)` and XORs in bulk:

```python
kb    = key.to_bytes(8, 'little')
mask  = (kb * ((n+7)//8))[:n]
return (int.from_bytes(d,'little') ^ int.from_bytes(mask,'little')).to_bytes(n,'li
ttle')
```

Output of `t256` is `1 byte mode + 8-byte key + xor'd data` (or `b'\x00'+d` when nothing beat raw). `r256` reads mode, extracts key, XORs back.

So "compress 64 bits of 32 keys" = *"try all 512 candidate 64-bit masks (of which the first 32 are the hard-coded constants), keep the one whose XOR-transformed payload zlib-compresses smallest"*. Selection only — the actual heavy compression happens later in `cback`.

3. What is compressed *after* `t256`

`compress()` runs a **three-phase tournament**, and `a256` is just one competitor in Phase 1:

```text
Phase 0  (optional)  t_xml pre-pass      → XML / DOCX container-aware transform
Phase 1  singles     for t in 1..256:    cback(fwd[t](data))            ← a256 com
petes here
Phase 2  pairs       for p in 1..65280:  cback(fwd[b](fwd[a](data)))    ← a256 all
owed as a or b
Phase 3  final cmix  force cmix(-c) on the Phase-1/2 winner
```

The only place heavy compression runs is `cback()` — `_cback_compute` fires these in parallel and keeps the smallest verified blob:

code	backend
0	raw
1	zstd-22 (and zstd-22 with REF_BYTES as dictionary, tag 11)
2/3	paq
4	brotli 11

code	backend
5/6/9	lzma-9e / lzma raw
8	pyppmd order 16
10	zpaq `-m5`
12	ccmx
13	cmix
14	lepton (JPEG inside DOCX)

Then if `HAS_CMIX` and `SKIP_SLOW=False`, `_final_cmix_pass` **re-runs cmix on the Phase-1/2 winner's already-transformed bytes** and only accepts the upgrade if it round-trips and shrinks the size:

```
python
new_blob = bytes([13]) + cmixc(transformed)          # tag 13 = cmix
if back != transformed:  keep original
if len(new_blob) < sz:   accept upgrade
```

4. Bottom line

- **"32 keys of 64 bits"** = the fixed seed of the candidate list in `_q64_candidates()`. They're not "the 32 keys" — they're just the first 32 of the 512 candidates `t256` tries.
- `t256` itself does no real compression — it just picks the best **XOR-mask** by scoring `zlib.compress(xor64(d,k), 1)`.
- Real compression is delegated to `cback()` (zstd-22 / brotli-11 / lzma-9e / ppmd-16 / paq / ccmx / cmix), and after the tournament the winner gets one last **forced cmix pass**.